



Home



My Network



Jobs



Messaging



Notifications



Me



For Business

[Edit article](#)[View stats](#)[View post](#)**Being Curious**
2,671 subscribers[✓ Subscribed](#)

The Future of Work: Disruption or Realignment?

**Vikas Surani**

Global Vice President – Growth | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



July 28, 2025

Hello Curious Minds,

Layoffs: 9,000 at Microsoft. 12,000 at TCS. 24,000 at Intel. Thousands more at Meta and Amazon.*

Is it a crisis? Or is it the correction we didn't see coming?

Let's not sugarcoat it—jobs are being lost, and headlines are turning cold. But underneath the wave of layoffs lies a deeper shift: **the workforce is being reshaped, not erased.**

What's really happening?

- **Microsoft** is channeling \$80B+ into AI infra this year. That shift demands efficiency and sharper focus. [Source](#)
- **TCS** is letting go of ~12,000—not due to excess bench, but due to a **skills mismatch** in a fast-changing landscape. [Source](#)
- **Intel** is restructuring to double down on its chip and AI strategy. Up to 24,000 roles impacted. [Source](#)
- **Meta and Amazon?** Trimming middle layers while doubling down on high-skilled AI hires. [Source](#)

This isn't just headcount reduction—it's a **strategic workforce pivot**.

The irony? **At the same time, the world needs more workers than ever—just different ones.**

WEF Report: Future of Jobs 2025

The **World Economic Forum** breaks it down simply:

▲ +170M new jobs ▼ -92M jobs displaced 📈 Net gain: 78M roles by 2030

Source – WEF Future of Jobs Report

Jobs aren't going away—they're moving upstream. Toward roles in AI, big data, clean tech, cybersecurity, and resilience engineering.

But here's the curveball:

40% of current skills will be outdated in just 5 years.

And that brings us to the bigger question...



What matters now?

Employers want:

- **AI literacy** – not to code it, but to work with it
- **Cognitive flexibility** – because playbooks are getting rewritten in real-time
- **Creativity & resilience** – the two most human skills machines still can't fake

One skill alone won't save us. But a mindset shift will.



What I'm reflecting on

- Resumes won't matter as much as **adaptability**.
- Career ladders will be replaced by **career lattices**—lateral moves, cross-skilling, and reinvention.
- And the best leaders? Will be those who **create psychological safety in uncertain times**, not just chase productivity.

Would like to hear—how are your re-skilling yourself or your team for what's next?

- Vikas Surani

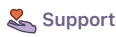


Future of Work x Vikas Surani

📖 *From the diaries:* Speaking at my alma mater, [Ahmedabad University](#), on the **Future of Work** — a moment that reminded me how curiosity and courage are timeless skills, whether you're just starting out or adapting mid-journey.

Comments

👍❤️ 49 · 8 comments · 1 repost

  Support  Comment  Share

Share your support...

Most recent ▼

 **Dhaval Thakkar** ✓ · 1st
Senior Field Service Engg @ John Crane | CMRP, VA CAT II
thoughtful insights..
[Like](#) · 🗨️ 1 | [Reply](#) 4mo ...

 **AI CERTs®**
23,899 followers
Curiosity truly is the key to staying relevant in this AI-driven shift. At AI CERTs, we encourage continuous learning and exploration as core elements of future-ready careers. Appreciate your insights on embracing change with the right mindset!
[Like](#) · 🗨️ 1 | [Reply](#) 4mo ...

 **SLAY**
587 followers
Change is the new normal. Let's grow with it.
[Like](#) · 🗨️ 1 | [Reply](#) 4mo ...

 **Harshil Raval** ✓ · 1st
Building Scalable Bid Management Function | Bid Management & ...
4mo ...

Kunal Shah once said, "Inefficiency is the biggest employer." That was true for a long time, globally. But those days are fading. Just like early humans transitioned from hunting to farming, freeing up time and energy to focus on more than just survival, we're now entering a similar shift with AI. The goal is no longer just to "hunt" for work or task ...more

Like · 1 | Reply



Jonathan Wright · 1st
Senior Leader | Managed Services | Professional Services | ITIL Se...

4mo ...

It would be interesting to see stats on how many of the organisations laying people off, proactively looked to re-skill their existing workforce rather than replace them. If those people have skills no longer aligned to requirements of today they will have to re-skill anyway! Rather than didn't we see this coming, didn't the large organisations you me ...more

Like · 5 | Reply



Upasna Gupta · 1st
HR Business Partner, UKI and Europe at Mastek

4mo ...

Very thought provoking insights [Vikas Surani](#) . While it's essential to adapt to evolving dynamics and develop AI literacy, human qualities like resilience, adaptability, and the ability to foster a sense of belonging remain irreplaceable.
The success of any organization eventually depends on its people ...more

Like · 2 | Reply · 1 reply



Denise Walker · 1st
Strategic business development specialising in Public Sector

4mo ...

[Upasna Gupta](#) Nicely put 🙌

Like · 1 | Reply



AI CERTs®
23,899 followers

4mo ...

Curiosity is truly the driver of growth in this era of AI transformation. At AI CERTs, we encourage a learning mindset to help professionals stay agile and ahead in the future of work. Thanks for sharing this inspiring message!

Like · 1 | Reply



Being Curious

A weekly newsletter where I share quick insights, experiences, and lessons learned from my journey.



Nikhilesh, Anjali and 2,446 connections are subscribed

2,671 subscribers

✓ Subscribed